

Homework for Chap 9

In a piece of semiconductor of GaAs, given the static dielectric constant is 12.9, the effective mass for electron is $0.067m_0$, the effective masses for heavy hole and light hole are $0.45m_0$ and $0.082 m_0$, respectively. Here m_0 is the rest mass of electron, and $m_0=9.11 \times 10^{-31}$ kg. Calculate the Bohr radius and binding energy of exciton ground state in GaAs. Please note that electron can form exciton with both heavy hole and light hole.

semiconductors :

$$1\text{meV} \leq Ry^* \leq 200\text{meV} \ll E_g$$

$$50\text{nm} \geq \alpha_B \geq 1\text{nm} > \alpha_{\text{lattice}}$$

Wannier Excitons

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According to Ξ parameters: $m_e = 0.067m_0$ $m_{hh} = 0.45m_0$ $m_{eh} = 0.082m_0$ ~~$m_{hh} = 0.082m_0$~~

The reduced exciton mass :

$$\mu = \frac{m_e m_h}{m_e + m_h}$$

$$\mu_{eh} = \frac{0.067m_0 \cdot 0.082m_0}{(0.067 + 0.082)m_0} \approx 0.0369m_0$$

$$\mu_{ehh} = \frac{0.45m_0 \cdot 0.067m_0}{(0.45 + 0.067)m_0} \approx 0.0583m_0$$

According to the definition of binding energy:

$$E_B = E_g - E_{ex} = Ry \cdot \frac{1}{n_B^2} - \frac{\hbar^2 k^2}{2M}$$

For direct gap ground state ($k=0$, $n_B=1$):

$$E_B = Ry = 13.6\text{eV} \cdot \frac{\mu}{m_0} \cdot \frac{1}{\epsilon^2}$$

$$\text{so: } E_B^{eh} = 13.6\text{eV} \cdot \frac{0.0369m_0}{m_0} \cdot \frac{1}{(12.9)^2} \approx 0.003\text{eV} = 3\text{meV}$$

$$E_B^{ehh} = 13.6\text{eV} \cdot \frac{0.0589m_0}{m_0} \cdot \frac{1}{(12.9)^2} \approx 0.0048\text{eV} = 4.8\text{meV}$$

For exciton Bohr Radius:

$$a_B^{ex} = a_B^H \cdot \epsilon \frac{m_0}{\mu}, \quad a_B^H = 5.29 \times 10^{-11}\text{m}$$

$$\# a_B^{eh} = 5.29 \times 10^{-11} \cdot 12.9 \cdot \frac{m_0}{0.0369m_0} \approx 18.5\text{nm} \quad a_B^{ehh} = 5.29 \times 10^{-11} \cdot 12.9 \cdot \frac{m_0}{0.0589m_0} \approx 11.7\text{nm}$$